

Akshay Raj

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❖ New Delhi

WORK EXPERIENCE

Indian Institute of Technology, Chennai

Project Associate

Sep 2023–Apr 2024

Chennai, Tamil Nadu

- Conducted comprehensive research, literature review, and synthesis to co-author a research paper on copulas in Malayalam.
- Collected and transcribed over 10 hours of audio and video data from native speakers for linguistic analysis.
- Documented and maintained the audio and video data for future reference and further research.
- Participated in collaborative brainstorming sessions and developed proposals for project grants from government and non-profit academic research funding bodies.
- Proofread and edited linguistic research papers to ensure accuracy in glossing and citations, identifying and addressing key shortcomings.
- Assisted in creating the final project report, ensuring thorough documentation and presentation of research findings.

Mozanta Tech.

Artificial Intelligence Engineer

Jan 2019–Apr 2021

Trivandrum, Kerala

- Led the development of a large-scale service-based chatbot using Azure in RESTful API format for French E-commerce fashion website.
- Deployed it on several social media platforms following AGILE methodology.
- Implemented collaborative filtering and product association machine learning models as part of a recommendation system module.
- Implemented several features for B2C fashion E-commerce platform where retailers customise, serve, and monitor the websites.
- Provided support and collaborated with cross-functional teams to identify and resolve technical issues.
- Integrated several python scripts into mainframe project to improve the development lifecycle.

Ebisu

Software Engineer

May 2018–Jul 2018

Bengaluru, Karnataka

- Understood the functionality of chatbot made for RPA.
- Created a scrapped dataset from reddit for the purpose of analysing clients' required market sentiment.
- Developed a classification/analysis system on written documents (tweets, blog, etc.) from the dataset using latent dirichlet allocation.

e-Bhasha, IIIT Hyderabad

Research Associate

June 2017–Aug 2017

Hyderabad

- Developed a lexicon in Malayalam for transliteration project parallelly becoming proficient in Perl programming language.
- Created a full-fledged Wx Keyboard in Malayalam from Hindi and English and vice-versa.

The New Indian Express

Journalism intern

May 2014–July 2014

Kozhikode, Kerala

- Ideated, researched, and wrote articles for the Sunday supplement of *The New Indian Express* which had readership of 3+ lakh.
- Curated over 10 articles throughout the period which got published in the daily.

EDUCATION

School of Liberal Arts, Indian Institute of Technology, Jodhpur

Doctor of Philosophy in Linguistics

December 2024–Present

Rajasthan

Centre for Applied Linguistics and Translation Studies, University of Hyderabad

Doctor of Philosophy in Applied Linguistics

2023–2024

Hyderabad

Centre for Linguistics, Jawaharlal Nehru University

Master of Arts in Linguistics

Thesis: Passive constructions in Ahirwati

June 2023

New Delhi

National Institute of Electronics & Information Technology

Advanced Diploma in Artificial Intelligence

Deelight: A unified deep learning assisted module for the visually impaired

Jan 2019

Calicut, Kerala

The English and Foreign Languages University

Master of Arts in Computational Linguistics

June 2018

Hyderabad

The English and Foreign Languages University

Bachelor of Arts (Hons.) in English

June 2016

Hyderabad

PUBLICATION

- Sahoo, A., Yap, F. H. & Raj, A. (2024). *From linking verb to auxiliation and focus marking: On the versatile uses of copulas in Malayalam, a Dravidian language. Studies in Language*. Manuscript in preparation.
- Raj, A. (2024). Argument structure alternation in Ahirwati. *Proceedings of All About Voice*. Manuscript in preparation.

PRESENTATION

- Raj, A. (2024). "Argument structure alternation in Ahirwati." Presented at the Students Conference on Linguistics 14 (SCONLI-14), Indian Institute of Technology, Kharagpur, 22 February, 2024.
- Raj, A. (2024). "From linking verb to auxiliation and focus marking: On the versatile uses of copulas in Malayalam, a Dravidian language" Presented at the 15th International Conference of the Association for Linguistic Typology (ALT-14), Nanyang Technological University, Singapore, 4 December, 2024.

THESIS

- **Passive constructions in Ahirwati:** Documentation and the morpho-syntactic analysis of the lesser-known language Ahirwati, belonging to the Rajasthani language subfamily under the Indo-Aryan family of languages.

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

- **DGfS International Scholarship, Deutsche Gesellschaft für Sprachwissenschaft (2026):** Awarded 2,500 EUR scholarship to attend the 2026 DGfS Summer School at Bielefeld University, covering tuition, travel, visa, accommodation, and living expenses.

PROJECTS

- **Malayalam news summariser:** Created an open-source, deep learning, Malayalam news summariser which can generate summaries as the headline to the news article. The deep learning algorithm uses the pretrained model. The project was built, influenced by a mainstream short news app. Project is hosted in the Huggingface repository.

SKILLS & INTERESTS

- **Programming:** Python, R, JavaScript, ReactJS, NodeJS, Shell, SQL, MongoDB, HTML CSS, Azure, XML, Scala
- **Linguistic Tools:** Praat, LaTeX.
- **Language:** English, Hindi, Malayalam